

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

CENTRAL FOCUS

Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

- [1] Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)

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- [2] The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially constructed even when biological difference is real. (PDF pp.84-86)

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- [3] The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers on equality, citizenship and justice. (PDF pp.88-90)

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- [4] The topic teaches how power can operate through family roles, labour division, culture and political exclusion, not only through law or property. (PDF pp.85-87)

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SYNTHESIS -> Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

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Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

- [1] Gender roles such as aggressiveness/dominance for men and submissiveness/expressiveness for women are treated as cultural instruments of social control. (PDF p.85)
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- [2] Patriarchy: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life. (PDF p.84)
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- [3] Gender: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men. (PDF pp.84-85)
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- [4] Gender inequality: a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)
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- [5] He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)
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SYNTHESIS -> Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

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Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

[1] Shulamith Firestone: radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change. (PDF p.89)

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[2] Kate Millett: radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology. (PDF p.89)

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[3] Sheila Rowbotham: socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions. (PDF pp.89-90)

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[4] Natural inequality vs conventional inequality: Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category. (PDF p.86)

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[5] Legal equality vs substantive equality: early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power. (PDF pp.88-91)

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SYNTHESIS -> Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

[1] Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)

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[2] The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because these exclusions had no necessary connection with female biology. (PDF pp.87-88)

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[3] A safe classroom example is to contrast biological maternity with culturally assigned ideas that women must therefore remain outside public life.

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SYNTHESIS -> Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

CENTRAL FOCUS

Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

- [1] Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93.

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- [2] Use Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction to show why gender hierarchy is alterable. (PDF p.86)

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- [3] Classify feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams with one thinker each. (PDF pp.88-90)

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- [4] End by warning against using Gauba's dated numerical claims as present-day evidence. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

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- [5] Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy, sex-gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and inequality (PDF pp.86-87); Wollstonecraft, Mill and three streams of feminism (PDF pp.88-90).

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SYNTHESIS -> Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

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Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

- [1] Exam use: if a question specifically says "Marxist feminism," lead with the domestic-labour/social-reproduction claim; if it says "socialist feminism," lead with Rowbotham's dual-systems synthesis; the two labels overlap but are not simple synonyms.

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- [2] Gauba's chapter grounds the sex/gender distinction and the liberal/radical/socialist typology; it does not itself discuss Simone de Beauvoir, Gayle Rubin, Ann Oakley, Carole Pateman, Susan Moller Okin, Judith Butler or Kimberlé Crenshaw. Everything below is a standard PSIR/political-theory extension used by examiners beyond this specific book, flagged throughout, and is not tied to a page number in the primary source.

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- [3] Ann Oakley (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology – sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.

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- [4] Claim: women's oppression is generated principally by the capitalist mode of production, especially unpaid domestic/reproductive labour that reproduces the workforce free of charge.

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SYNTHESIS -> Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

CENTRAL FOCUS

Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

[1] Susan Moller Okin (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim – theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine. Evidence – unequal domestic burden restricts women's access to the "primary goods" (time, income, position) public justice is meant to distribute. Significance – extends justice from state/market into the household. Limit – risks over-extending justice into every private relationship, which is why most syntheses still preserve some sphere of family autonomy alongside gender-just background conditions.

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SYNTHESIS -> Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

CENTRAL FOCUS

Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

[1] Judith Butler (Gender Trouble, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but performative – produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress, behaviour) that create the appearance of a natural gendered self; on this account even "sex" is partly constituted through gendered discourse, not a wholly pre-discursive bedrock.

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SYNTHESIS -> Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

CENTRAL FOCUS

Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

[1] Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights. Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. Present as a live, contested debate – not a settled result.

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[2] Objection: radical feminism's emphasis on patriarchy as the primary, near-universal structure of oppression risks treating "women" as one undifferentiated class, erasing differences of race, class and caste among women. Reply: Crenshaw's intersectionality and Marxist/socialist feminism's attention to class supply the corrective – oppression is compounded and differently configured across axes, producing a more accurate map of whose subordination is being explained. This reply strengthens rather than replaces the original radical-feminist insight that sexual/reproductive domination is analytically distinct from class or race domination.

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SYNTHESIS -> Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

CENTRAL FOCUS

Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

- [1] "Distinguish sex and gender" → definitional/analytical directive: give the distinction plus why it matters, not two one-line definitions.

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- [2] "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" → needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.

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- [3] "Critically examine feminist perspectives on X" → requires thesis + at least two schools compared + at least one objection/reply, ending in a reasoned verdict, not a neutral list.

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- [4] Thesis (1-2 lines): feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender distinction; formal legal equality alone is insufficient.

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- [5] Body: sex vs gender (claim→evidence→significance) + one stream (liberal/radical/socialist/Marxist) with its core mechanism.

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SYNTHESIS -> Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

- [1] Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

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- [2] Patriarchy: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

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- [3] Sex: biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

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- [4] Gender: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

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SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] Butler's Gender Trouble argues gender is constituted through performative repetition of stylised acts within a regulatory, discursive frame -- there is no gendered substance prior to or behind the repeated acts. This treats gender as thoroughly cultural: produced, disciplined, and reproduced through social practice, in contrast to sex, which denotes a biological given. The cultural-category reading explains variation across societies and time in what counts as masculine or feminine, which a purely biological account cannot.

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[2] Formal equality demands the removal of explicit differential rules; substantive equality goes further, licensing affirmative measures to correct unequal starting points; relational equality asks whether social relationships remain hierarchical regardless of formal rules. Empowerment, on Kabeer's tripartite model, requires resources, agency, and achievements -- it is the process by which formal or substantive equality is actually converted into lived capacity. On this reading, equality supplies the normative target and empowerment supplies the causal mechanism by which that target is reached.

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SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.